

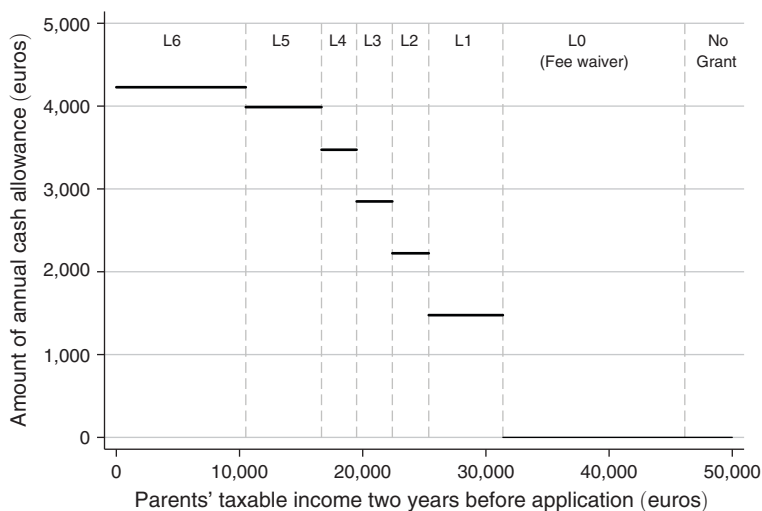


FIGURE 2. AMOUNT OF ANNUAL CASH ALLOWANCE AWARDED TO APPLICANTS WITH A FNA SCORE OF 3 POINTS, AS FUNCTION OF THEIR PARENTS' TAXABLE INCOME

Notes: The figure shows the amount of annual cash allowance awarded in 2009 to BCS grant applicants with a family needs assessment (FNA) score of 3 points (median value), as a function of their parents' taxable income two years before the application. Applicants eligible for a level 0 grant qualify for fee waivers only. Applicants eligible for higher levels of grant qualify for fee waivers and an annual cash allowance, the amount of which varies with the level of grant: 1,476 euros (level 1), 2,223 euros (level 2), 2,849 euros (level 3), 3,473 euros (level 4), 3,988 euros (level 5) and 4,228 euros (level 6). Income thresholds and allowance amounts are expressed in 2011 euros.

a typical university year) two years in a row. In other words, grant renewal is suspended after two consecutive failures in a given year level. Eligible students are also required to comply with the attendance requirements set by their university and to take all of the exams. Failure to meet these requirements may lead to the repayment of the allowance received by the student.¹⁶

Application Process.—The grant application process for students who are planning to enroll or to re-enroll in a higher education institution begins in the January preceding the start of the academic year and spans over several months. Individual applications are processed by the regional branches of the national student service agency (CNOUS). The main application steps can be summarized as follows.

- *Official online application round (January 15–April 30).* Students apply jointly for need-based grants and for student housing (optional) on a dedicated website.¹⁷ They can submit up to four preregistration applications, as

¹⁶Unfortunately, the extent to which these regulations are enforced in practice cannot be measured from our data. This is because the exact reason for why certain applicants are denied a conditional grant despite being eligible on the basis of their parental income and FNA score is not specified. These grounds include not only the noncompliance with the minimum academic achievement requirements but also the withdrawal of some applications or the failure to send all of the supporting documents to the student service agency.

¹⁷<https://dse.orion.education.fr/depot/>.